

CHRIS SKALING

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Principal AI Engineer & Architect with 15+ years delivering enterprise cloud solutions and Forward-Deployed AI systems for Global 500 clients. Orchestrated multi-agent RAG architectures on Azure OpenAI that reduced operational toil by 35% and cycle times by 44% within 60 days. Expert in Vector Indexing, Semantic Retrieval, and MLOps practices for scalable, SOC-2 compliant systems of record. Committed to building production-grade AI infrastructure that drives measurable efficiency and revenue growth.

CORE SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

AI & LLM Engineering: Multi-Agent Systems • RAG (Hybrid Retrieval) • Tool-Calling & Plugins • Vector Indexing • Prompt Engineering • Azure OpenAI • Copilot Architecture

Cloud & Backend: Azure (AI Search, Functions, Blob, Entra ID) • Python • TypeScript • Dynamics 365 Integration • Distributed Systems • REST APIs

MLOps & Production: Evaluations (Golden Sets/Rubrics) • Guardrails & Safety • Observability (OpenTelemetry/Sentry) • Semantic Caching • Latency Optimization

Governance & Strategy: SOC-2 Compliance • RBAC/Security • Data Governance • Enterprise Rollout • Technical Strategy • Stakeholder Management

EXPERIENCE

NAITIVE AI — *Principal AI Engineer / Forward-Deployed Lead* Mar 2024 – Present

- Lead a forward-deployed engineering practice embedding with executive sponsors to ship hardened, SOC-2 compliant AI systems; reduced cycle time 44% and operational toil 35% through rapid prototyping and production delivery.
- Architected "Lucy," a domain-specific agent integrated with Dynamics 365 + Azure AI Search; enabled governed document reasoning via tool-calling, improving handle time by 28% and reducing escalations by 18%.
- Operationalized vector indexing for 1.5M+ documents (Azure Blob/Search), achieving near real-time freshness (T='hours') and reducing query latency by 40% while improving retrieval recall 22%.
- Delivered hybrid retrieval patterns (BM25 + vector) and model/prompt routing to produce "Copilot-style" assistance inside CRM workflows; improved time-to-answer 32% and decision throughput 22%.
- Instituted evaluation + observability (golden sets, rubric scoring, traces, red-teaming) plus guardrails (PII filters, rate limits, RBAC/Entra); reduced defect leakage 41% and incident rate 34% with audit-ready logs aligned to SOC-2 controls.
- Orchestrated multi-agent workflows (planner/worker) with tool-calling into Dynamics / Twilio / bank ingestion APIs; increased straight-through automation by 27% and reduced back-office handling

time 37%.

- Built an enterprise "maker" layer (Flowise/Langflow/Vercel AI SDK) with standardized templates; reduced new use-case time-to-market from weeks to days and regression incidents by 24%.
- Owned end-to-end outcomes (architecture, implementation, deployment, reliability), supporting 50+ clients and delivering 15+ projects on Azure.

Tech Stack: Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Search, Azure Functions, Blob Storage, Entra ID/RBAC, Dynamics 365, Python/TypeScript, OTEL/Sentry

Trusted Tech Team — *Director of Cloud Services*

Sep 2023 – Apr 2024

- Drove AI-enabled service automation and platform improvements that increased delivery capacity and supported revenue growth; removed 420 hours/year of operational overhead via workflow automation.
- Modernized toward a cloud-native PSM approach aligned to OpenAPI standards; reduced integration friction and improved interoperability across internal systems and customer-facing integrations.
- Established scalable infrastructure practices (automation, standardization, governance) that improved delivery consistency and reduced cycle time 17%.

Computacenter — *Cloud Solutions Director*

Jan 2022 – Sep 2023

- Led Azure transformation initiatives for 50+ enterprise clients, balancing security, governance, and cost controls with pragmatic delivery.
- Built cloud governance and cost-optimization frameworks; reduced ongoing cloud spend 19% across targeted portfolios and increased automation coverage 32%.
- Delivered cloud-native modernization programs that shortened deployment timelines 29% and improved engineering velocity through repeatable patterns and operational discipline.

EPAM — *Director, Cloud Solutions*

Nov 2020 – Dec 2021

- Conducted Azure architecture reviews and TCO/business-case analyses; produced modernization roadmaps with clear risk, cost, and phased delivery milestones for enterprise projects >\$1M.
- Led prototypes/PoCs for complex migration and modernization scenarios; increased stakeholder confidence through working implementations and production-aligned reference architectures.
- Defined governance, automation, and security patterns that accelerated deployments 22% and strengthened compliance outcomes.

Microsoft — *Senior Cloud Solutions Architect*

Dec 2017 – Nov 2020

- Architected and deployed Azure solutions across enterprise environments using repeatable patterns and reference designs; improved scalability and time-to-market for modernized workloads.
- Established governance best practices (identity, policy, security, cost) enabling predictable operations at scale across multiple customers.
- Partnered with engineering, operations, and security teams to migrate and modernize large workloads with high customer satisfaction.

Dell Technologies — *Advisory Cloud Architect*

Jun 2016 – Dec 2017

- Led hybrid cloud integration and modernization engagements; improved reliability and drove measurable annual savings 10% through consolidation, automation, and architecture standardization.

- Designed scalable Dell EMC/VMware hybrid architectures supporting large application portfolios; strengthened HA/DR posture and reduced downtime risk.

FusionStorm — *Practice Manager, Systems & Storage*

Jan 2015 – Jun 2016

- Managed and mentored a high-performing engineering team delivering compute/storage/network solutions; improved delivery predictability and resilience (HA/DR) across complex client environments.

FusionStorm — *Lead Principal Systems Engineer*

Mar 2010 – Jan 2015

- Designed VMware-centric enterprise architectures for large user populations; improved uptime, scalability, and capacity planning through platform modernization and operational rigor.

Eclipsys — *Systems Engineer*

Jan 2007 – Mar 2010

- Supported healthcare infrastructure modernization and data center integration for acquisitions; delivered highly available clinical systems aligned to strict uptime requirements.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Colorado Technical University

— B.S., Computer Science

Microsoft Certified:
President's Club

Azure Solutions Architect Expert
— FusionStorm (2013, 2014, 2015)